

Ugur Mert Yasar

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Education

The University of Chicago Booth School of Business, IL

Expected June 2027

PhD, Behavioral Science

MBA

Harvard University, MA

July 2026 – June 2027

Visiting PhD Student, Department of Psychology

University of British Columbia, BC

June 2020

Bachelor of International Economics, Vancouver School of Economics

Thesis: Islamic Rule's Effects on Women's Labor Force Participation: Evidence from Turkey

Doctoral Dissertation

Title: Essays on the Formal and Informal Enforcement of Social Norms provisional

Committee: Joshua Conrad Jackson (Chair), James A. Robinson, Devin Pope, Joshua T. Dean, Thomas Talhelm

Research Interests

Rules, norms, cultural tightness, institutional economics, social learning, argumentativeness

Working Papers

1. **Yasar, U. M.**, Jackson, J. C., Yao, H., Kowal, M., & Sorokowski, P. "The Global Architecture of Social Norms: Content and Enforcement." 92 societies, 44 languages, ~18,400 participants. [*Job Market Paper; data analysis in progress*]
2. **Yasar, U. M.**, & Jackson, J. C. "Rulebooks and Relationships: An Institutional Model of Cultural Tightness." [*Invited proposal, Perspectives on Psychological Science*]
3. **Yasar, U. M.**, & Jackson, J. C. "Kin is King: Familial Status Inflation in Non-WEIRD Cultures." [*Complete manuscript available on request*]
4. Jackson, J. C., **Yasar, U. M.**, Liu, Y., & Dorison, C. "Social Learning Can Produce Costly Status Quo Preferences Without a Status Quo Bias." [*Complete manuscript available on request*]

Research Projects

5. **Yasar, U. M.**, Jackson, J. C., Yao, H., Kowal, M., & Sorokowski, P. "Deconstructing Cultural Tightness: Formal and Informal Dimensions of Norm Enforcement Across 92 Cultures." [*Data analysis in progress*]
6. **Yasar, U. M.**, Jackson, J. C., Yao, H., Kowal, M., & Sorokowski, P. "Cultural Tightness-Looseness Revisited After 15 Years: Updated Scores and Correlates Across 92 Cultures." [*Data analysis in progress*]
7. **Yasar, U. M.**, Talhelm, T., Wei, L., Kowal, M., & Sorokowski, P. "Argumentativeness as a Cultural Trait: Self-Reports and Culture-Reports Across 92 Countries." [*Data analysis in progress*]
8. **Yasar, U. M.**, Zhang, S., & Jackson, J. C. "Substitutes or Complements? Formal and Informal Enforcement in a Public Goods Game." [*Pilot data analysis*]
9. **Yasar, U. M.**, Jackson, J. C., & Pope, D. "Enemy at the Board: How Political Tension Predicts Unsportsmanlike Behavior in International Chess." [*Data analysis in progress*]

Awards and Honors

Global Health Summer Fellowship , Center for Global Health, The University of Chicago — \$7,500	2023
Development Economics Research Fund , Becker Friedman Institute, The University of Chicago — \$4,578 (<i>Declined</i>)	2022
Work-Learn International Undergraduate Research Award , University of British Columbia — CAD \$7,000	2018
Outstanding Practicum Award , University of British Columbia — CAD \$8,000	2015

Presentations

“The Global Architecture of Social Norms: Content and Enforcement” Yasar, U. M., & Jackson, J. C.

- *Organized Symposium* (Co-Chair): “The Lifecycle of Norms: Novel Insights from Around the World,” Society for Personality and Social Psychology, Chicago (February 2026)
- *Invited Talk*: International Association for Conflict Management, Burlington (July 2025)

“Kin is King: Familial Status Inflation in Non-WEIRD Cultures” Yasar, U. M., & Jackson, J. C.

- *Invited Talk*: Society for Personality and Social Psychology, Denver (February 2025)
- *Invited Talk*: Behavioral Brownbag, Booth School of Business, The University of Chicago (May 2024)

“Argumentativeness as a Cultural Trait: Self-Reports and Culture-Reports Across 92 Countries” Yasar, U. M., Talhelm, T., & Wei, L.

- *Poster*: Global Health Research Symposium, Biological Sciences Division, The University of Chicago (October 2023)

Teaching

Teaching Assistant, The University of Chicago

The Study of Behavioral Economics

Winter 2024, 2025, 2026

MBA, Chicago · *Professor Devin Pope*

Statistics

Autumn 2024 – Winter 2025

Executive MBA, Hong Kong and London · *Professor Chris Hansen*

Behavioral Economics: Development and Observational Data

Autumn 2023

PhD, Chicago · *Professors Devin Pope and Joshua T. Dean*

Managerial Decision Making

Autumn 2023

Executive MBA, Hong Kong · *Professor Chris Hsee*

Behavioral Economics: Theory and the Lab

Spring 2023

PhD, Chicago · *Professor Alex Imas*

Behavioral Economics

Spring 2023

Undergraduate, Chicago · *Professor Alex Imas*

Research Experience

Research Assistant

2020 – 2021

Vancouver School of Economics, University of British Columbia · *Professor Matt Lowe*

Research Assistant, Culture and Self Lab

2019 – 2021

University of British Columbia · *Professor Steven J. Heine*

Research Assistant, Motivation and Goals in Contexts (MAGIC) Lab

2018 – 2021

University of British Columbia · *Professor Kristin Laurin*

Research Assistant

2018

Sauder School of Business, University of British Columbia · *Professor Álvaro Parra*

Skills

Software R, Stata, Python, SPSS, Qualtrics

Languages Turkish (native), English (fluent), Spanish (beginner)

References

To be announced